

White Box: The hacker, is given all the necessary information about the infrastructure and network of the organization. This simulates an insider with access trying to attack the organisation's data from within. It's a lot easier to identify bugs when source codes are made available, and also can flag security holes that can be misused from within the company's employees.

Pen testing also has its caveats. It can leave the system malfunctioning or sometimes cause data loss. The company also has to balance the risk of exposing its entire infrastructure to the pen-tester(s).

Setting up your pc for pen-testing

For our tutorial we'll need the following three:

- VMware workstation
- Kali Linux virtual image
- Windows XP virtual image



Virtual environment

When you're pen-testing your setup, the recommended practice is to use a virtual environment so that if things go awry, your core OS does not have to bear the brunt. Virtual environments are created in virtual machines, and in our use case scenario, virtual machines are sort of 'fake' machines that run inside your 'real' machine. The "host" is the actual operating system that you use and any virtual machine that runs on the host is a "guest". This host-guest setup is implemented to act as a bulwark against any external attempts to hack the system. For